

One ICP. Two operating companies. One founder-led foundry.

We run an umbrella with two operating businesses, Product (Rollup) and Services (CoverPanda Services), plus an adjacent founder-led entity, **Franchise Foundry** (the evolution of B&B Management), that operates brands, does deals, and funnels franchise systems into both. One ICP across all three: the growth-stage franchisor. Since April the market priced our category, the ownership architecture got ratified, the metrics went bank-verified, and the adjacent seat got its CEO.

Rollup · the product and AI company

Vertical AI SaaS + embedded payments + the data layer · CTO Kayden Thomson · holds voting control of the umbrella with an economic floor of 51%

↓ owns 51%+ of

CoverPanda Services · the umbrella

AI-native back-office: CFO/advisory at the brand level; bookkeeping, payroll-adjacent services for franchisees · CEO Jared Nielsen · arms born 100% umbrella-owned, operators earn up to 25%

Franchise Foundry · adjacent, founder-led

STRUCTURE IN DEFINITION

Operator portfolio (portco #1: the B&B stores) · acquisitions and brand plays · advisory + capital connect · the audience engine · CEO & co-founder Shideler Bennett, co-founder Taylor Byington · commercially coupled to both opcos, arms-length

The market agreed with the thesis, in public, with money.

The category got priced

Delightree raised \$25M (Accel) as the ops OS for franchising: 6,000+ locations, ~20x in two years. Haven crossed \$15M ARR as an AI-native accounting firm in ~3 years. One proved the vertical, one proved the engine. **Neither holds the money-and-compliance layer. We are the intersection, and the window to own it is roughly 12 to 24 months.**

The structure got ratified

Rollup on top with voting control and a 51% economic floor in the umbrella; every new services arm born 100% umbrella-owned with operators earning up to 25%; comp and equity architecture signed by the leadership team in August, to counsel this week.

The numbers went bank-verified

Mercury connected across all three entities in August: the Friday scoreboard now runs on pulls, not estimates. If a number isn't from a pull, it doesn't go in a report.

The adjacent seat got real

B&B evolves into **Franchise Foundry** with Shideler as CEO & co-founder: the founder-led operator/deal layer the April brief drew, now with its operator committed to it full-heartedly. Terms in definition this week. The Head of Sales seat opens for a dedicated closer (Taylor interim).

Same three reasons as April. All three got stronger.

Two opcos, one buyer

Rollup and Services sell to the same franchisor with one sales motion. The sentence stays the sentence: "We automate your royalties and give you the financial insights to coach your franchisees." Exit-ready is where the relationship goes.

Foundry is a different motion

Founder-led, in-person, deals and operating credibility. Different rhythm, different deliverables, different risk. Adjacent, not absorbed, keeps the model honest and the books clean. New since April: it is also the audience engine; Delightree and Haven have no founder-led narrative from inside the space. We do.

Different valuation realities

Product 10–15× · services 4–8× with the AI premium · the blended platform multiple (12–18×) only arrives at ~65% gross margin with product at half the mix. Foundry's hybrid advisory/portfolio value stays cleanly separated so it never muddies either multiple.

Ops companies own the checklist. We own the FDD. The books beneath every unit, royalties computed on real revenue, and the compliance record every franchise system legally cannot skip: that layer is the moat, and every roadmap item earns its place by moving up it.

The growth-stage franchisor, bought at the finance seat.

Who buys	The franchisor's CFO or finance lead. Not the CEO, not the bookkeeper.
The profile	25–50 units open (center ~40), 50–100 sold. Sold-but-unopened units are the services runway: every opening needs books from day one with us standing there as preferred vendor.
The filter	POS coverage IS targeting: Mindbody · Square · Crisp · Stripe · Toast.
The economics	Platform \$249/mo + \$46/unit/mo · bookkeeping \$450/mo per franchisee · one ICP brand fully stacked ≈ \$72K blended ARR · one flagship (Swig-scale) ≈ \$200K+ year one.
New since April	The accountant-firm channel: firm workspace free, connected entities at wholesale, brand consolidation as the firm's premium product. Firms are distribution into units AND the door into brands they already serve. First firms named and in motion.

The activation machine works. August's job is pointing it.

STATE OF PLAY

WHERE IT STANDS

Adoption

PROVEN

186 adopted product units, +42 in a single week (+29.2%), paying-without-outcome nearly halved. The Square POS ingestion run is the template. Bar: 300 adopted by Sep 30.

The rails

LIVE

Royalty collection on real POS revenue live with first brands, Stella's switching collection to us Sept 1, first franchise agreement executed through the closing portal (Rio Açai). The bill.com/Ramp layer for franchising is the build direction.

Accountant portal

V1 NOW

The August star: it beat our own services team's tooling. V1 goes into the first firm's hands this month; it is the product side of the firm channel and the door to brand consolidation revenue.

Integrations

Mindbody + Square shipped · Toast/Crisp on the path · next data domains: labor, payroll, scheduling, rounding out what a CFO actually needs. Matt owns payments + POS, reporting to Kayden.

Honest flags

WAU and onboarding invitations fell while the machine connected units: the human motion must restart · Stripe SaaS connector down (product revenue reads from bank deposits until fixed) · DonutNV health debt is the largest churn risk (77 paying, 14 healthy).

Build-less-activate-more stands. The roadmap test is unchanged: does it help activate units, make an accountant's or CFO's job easier, or unlock something sales can sell. Otherwise it waits.

Cash-flow positive today. The engine the whole structure stands on.

STATE OF PLAY

WHERE IT STANDS

The engine

GENERATIVE

~\$35K MRR across 105 active subscriptions, generating surplus monthly. The Pilot-pattern operating company, working as designed.

Collections

THE PRIORITY

The single biggest lever in the company: past-due subscriptions worth ~\$18.6K/mo, a third of subscription dollars. Target: under \$9K by Aug 31. AR already cut by \$18K in three days; the motion works when run.

The firm channel

Terry (74 units, the designated first firm) onboarding starts now, targeting 100% by year-end · firm #2 named from the Akerman summit · the 11/10 delivery standard is the bar for our own work and every future marketplace firm.

The funnels (from April, now measured)

Brand-referred franchisees: 50% conversion is the standard, 75% is the excellence bar · broker/FSO referrals live (Sidekick renewed; Franzy signs when ready) · Foundry funnel formalized below.

The margin path

45% → 65% gross margin, with elected growth-burn stated quarterly. This path is the single biggest lever on the blended multiple, which is to say on everyone's outcome.

The founder-led layer the April brief drew. Now it has its operator.

April's brief said it plainly: adjacent only counts if it funnels. August's answer: give the adjacent entity a full-time CEO whose strengths are exactly its job description: deals, relationships, operating credibility, and an audience inside the space. **Shideler leads Franchise Foundry as CEO & co-founder.** Structure and terms are in definition this week; the shape below is the working frame.

COMPONENT	THE FRAME
What it holds	The operating portfolio as portco #1 · acquisitions and brand plays (concept conversions, distressed opportunities, international entries via the attorney network) · advisory and capital connect · the founder-led content and audience engine.
The coupling	Every Foundry brand runs the CoverPanda stack at arms-length pricing (the incubated case-study engine) · referrals both directions at standard rates · sourced-revenue commissions on brands Shideler brings to the opcos · funnel KPIs set together: brand intros per quarter, sourced ARR, content cadence.
Why it matters strategically	Delightree and Haven bought their credibility with capital. Ours is native: operators who live in the space, an audience that trusts them, and a portfolio that eats our own cooking in public. The most expensive growth is being an outsider paying for it; the cheapest is being the insider everyone already knows.
Boundaries	Cleanly separated books · no entity-level cross-equity for now (case-by-case JVs on real deals) · mutual preferred-vendor and non-solicit covenants · external positioning simple and truthful.

With the Foundry seat filled, the dedicated Head of Sales seat at CoverPanda opens for a closer who wants to live in the pipeline. Taylor owns sales in the interim; relationship-held deals stay with the people who hold them.

Collect. Activate. Close. Cash-flow positive by ~October 1.

SCOREBOARD

STATUS · AUGUST

The year	Services \$1.25M · Product \$750K · Company \$2.0M target, \$2.5M stretch , from the reconciled \$733K baseline. ~\$45K MRR today against ~\$167K exit run-rate implied: the gap is carried by named moves (300-unit bar, Terry, Swig, the firm channel, the 20-logo blend), each with an owner and a month.
The gates	Sep 30: Swig royalty rail + 300 adopted units · Oct 31: first firm-sourced brand intro · Dec 15: the decision gate where the data speaks and we listen, together.
The cash plan	Combined cash-flow positive ~October 1 on contracted revenue alone: collections + new wins at pace + the firm channel + Melty, with services' surplus as the buffer. No pipeline counted before signature, no new payroll before break-even.
The cadence	Daily standup · Friday scoreboard from pulls · monthly partner meeting with financials pre-circulated · quarterly gate checks. Positions problems get named at the month mark, not year-end.

Clear lanes don't mean separate games. The logos sales signs hand services their units. The books services keeps make the product smarter. Everything product ships makes the next sale easier. And everything Foundry touches funnels home.

Six moves. Every one already has an owner.

1 · Collect	Past-due under \$9K by Aug 31; decision on the 90-day tail. (Services)
2 · Activate	Melty live in weeks not months · DonutNV health closed via the Square template · invitations motion restarted. (Product)
3 · Arm the accountants	Portal v1 in Terry's hands with services alongside; firm #2 meeting held. (Product + Services + Taylor)
4 · Close the two that move the year	Swig to signature; Terry onboarding underway. (Taylor + the relationships that hold them)
5 · Define Foundry	Terms landed in one session, papered with counsel alongside the ratified structure. (Taylor + Shideler)
6 · Keep the scoreboard honest	Stripe SaaS connector fixed · pipeline amounts real · disputed figures reconciled before anything is quoted externally. (Everyone)

CoverPanda × Rollup × Franchise Foundry · internal team brief · V4 · August 2026 · supersedes V3 (April) · structural terms ratify with counsel; Foundry terms in definition · not for distribution